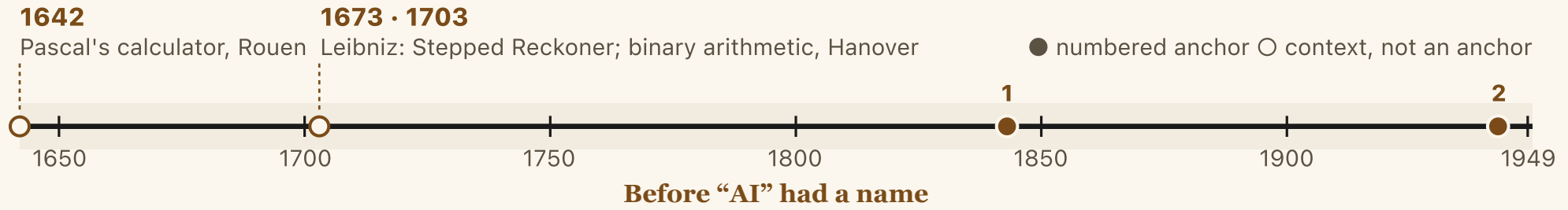


A Short History of Artificial Intelligence

From Lovelace's note to the 2024 Nobel Prizes · seventeen moments, two winters · page 1 of 2: 1642–1949



1 1843

Ada Lovelace publishes the first algorithm for a machine

Notes on Babbage's (designed, never built) Analytical Engine: the Engine "has no pretensions whatever to originate anything." London.

2 1943

First mathematical model of an artificial neuron

Warren McCulloch and Walter Pitts, Chicago.

The oldest machines were built by believers: Pascal (1642) and Leibniz (1703). Lovelace's "no pretensions to originate" is a 180-year-old Berean caution.

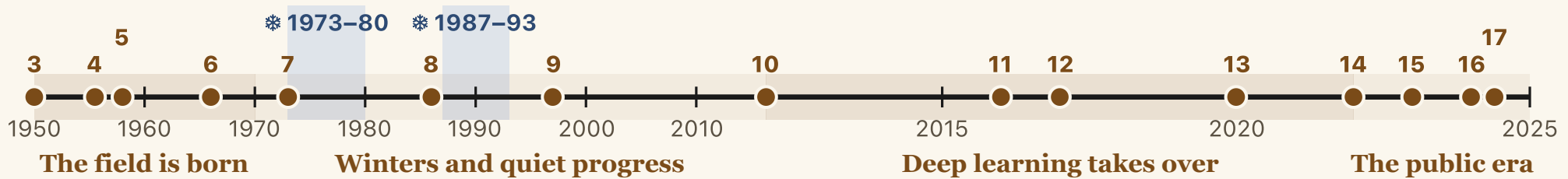
Two winters, both from overpromising. Then data, chips, and the transformer arrived together; in 2024 the Nobel committees called it science.

Sources: W8.1_timeline_facts.md (primary sources per row; Dartmouth, Perceptron, backpropagation, and the Nobel citations verified October 2026).

A Short History of Artificial Intelligence

Kaleidoscope · Valley Presbyterian Church · October 17, 2026

Page 2 of 2 · 1950–2024 · the years after 2011 are drawn at 2.8× the scale of 1950–2011 · ❄️ AI winter



3 1950
Turing proposes the Imitation Game
“Computing Machinery and Intelligence,”
Mind, October 1950. Manchester.

6 1966
ELIZA: people confide in a pattern-matching “therapist”
Joseph Weizenbaum, MIT. Users attributed understanding to it.

9 1997
Deep Blue defeats world champion Garry Kasparov
IBM; six-game match in New York, May 3–11, 1997.

12 2017
“Attention Is All You Need”: the Transformer
Vaswani et al., Google. The architecture behind every modern language model.

15 2023
GPT-4 and Claude released on the same day
OpenAI and Anthropic, San Francisco, March 14, 2023.

4 1955–56
The field gets its name: “artificial intelligence”
Dartmouth proposal (McCarthy, Minsky, Rochester, Shannon), written 1955; summer workshop 1956. Hanover, NH.

7 1973
The Lighthill Report: the first AI winter begins
Sir James Lighthill, for the UK Science Research Council.

10 2012
AlexNet wins ImageNet; deep learning on GPUs becomes the default
Krizhevsky, Sutskever, Hinton, University of Toronto.

13 2020
AlphaFold2 solves the 50-year protein-structure problem
Hassabis and Jumper, DeepMind, London; CASP14, November 30, 2020.

16 2024
Nobel Prize in Physics: Hopfield and Hinton
“For foundational discoveries and inventions that enable machine learning with artificial neural networks.” Oct. 8.

5 1957–59
The Perceptron: the first trainable neural network
Frank Rosenblatt, Cornell Aeronautical Lab, Buffalo. IBM 704 software 1958; Mark I hardware 1959.

8 1986
Backpropagation popularized for training deep networks
Rumelhart, Hinton, Williams, Nature, October 1986. (The method existed earlier.)

11 2016
AlphaGo defeats Lee Sedol 4–1 in Go
Google DeepMind, London; match in Seoul, March 9–15, 2016.

14 2022
ChatGPT released; about a million users in five days
OpenAI, San Francisco, November 30, 2022.

17 2024
Nobel Prize in Chemistry: Baker; Hassabis and Jumper (AlphaFold)
Half to David Baker (protein design); half to Demis Hassabis and John Jumper. Oct. 9.